



IT Software Procurement Policy

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1. Objective:

- 1.1 This policy defines a controlled and secure process for procurement, licensing, and deployment of software on all systems connected to the PCL network, ensuring compliance, cybersecurity resilience, and legal protection.

2. Scope:

- 2.1 This policy applies to:
- Operating systems and application software
 - Cloud, SaaS, AI, automation, and analytics tools
 - Open-source, freeware, shareware, and licensed software
 - Vendor-supplied embedded or bundled software

3. Applicability:

- 3.1 This policy shall be applicable to all employees, departments, contractors, and third parties using software on PCL-managed or PCL-connected systems.

4. Current Risk Context:

- 4.1 Decentralized software procurement by business units introduces risks including:
- Malware and ransomware infections
 - License violations and legal penalties
 - Data leakage through unvetted SaaS and AI tools
 - Absence of patching and vulnerability management

5. Policy Statement:

- 5.1 All software must be approved, procured, licensed, and deployed by IT.
- 5.2 Business units are prohibited from:
- Directly purchasing or subscribing to software
 - Installing freeware, cracked, or trial software
 - Using personal or vendor-provided licenses on PCL systems
- 5.3 Software identified after deployment without IT approval shall be removed immediately.

6. Software Procurement Workflow

- 6.1 Business submits functional requirement to IT



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- 6.2 IT evaluates:
- Security posture and vendor reputation
 - Data handling and privacy risks
 - Integration and compatibility
- 6.3 IT approves or rejects software
- 6.4 Procurement manages licensing and contracts
- 6.5 IT performs secure installation and configuration
- 6.6 Software recorded in license and asset registers

7. Cyber Security & Compliance Controls

- 7.1 All approved software must:
- 7.1.1 Be licensed to Pakistan Cables Limited
 - 7.1.2 Support MFA, encryption, and access controls
 - 7.1.3 Comply with PCL Information Classification standards
 - 7.1.4 Undergo periodic vulnerability and usage review
 - 7.1.5 Any software found non-compliant with defined security standards shall be blocked from network access until restored to compliance.

8. AI, Cloud & SaaS Controls

- 8.1 AI and SaaS tools must undergo data protection and risk assessment
- 8.2 Entry of confidential or restricted data into external tools is prohibited unless explicitly approved
- 8.3 Shadow AI and unsanctioned SaaS usage is strictly prohibited

9. Audits & Reporting

- 9.1 The IT Department shall monitor software installations and usage.
- 9.2 Compliance audit and license reconciliation reports shall be submitted to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) for review and record.
- 9.3 Any non-compliant software/applications shall be removed from the network.

10. Enforcement & Review

- 10.1 Non-compliance may lead to software isolation or procurement rejection.



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- 10.2 Any exceptions to this policy shall require prior written approval from the Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

APPROVED BY
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER